

Terrence Gillespie

Principal Design Engineer / Brisbane

Dear Poolside Design Team,

Poolside is building the models and agentic tools I already design around every day. The Design Engineer role, holding the bar across product, brand, marketing and systems while writing the code that ships, is the work I do now and want to do at frontier scale. I prototype interfaces in HTML, CSS and JS, iterate them against the model, and hand engineering working components instead of static files. That loop is how I think.

I'm Principal Design Engineer at Westpac, one of Australia's four major banks, where I'm custodian of the native design system across iOS and Android for 4 million daily users, and I lead the team behind GEL, our web system built on Next.js. It's a high-stakes, data-rich domain, payments, identity and fraud, and it ships fast. I led the design of SafeCall and SafeBlock, scam-prevention features that protect customers at the moment they're being defrauded. The app has been rated number one in Australia by Forrester three years running, and number one for access and inclusion by the Australian Disability Network. I treat the design system as product infrastructure: tokens, components and the patterns that let teams move fast without losing craft.

Building AI and agentic experiences is my daily work. Version control, the command line, local builds and deployment are where I already live, and agentic coding tools are part of how I work, not a curiosity. I take a problem to a coded prototype, refine it against the model, and hand engineering a working reference, proving the interaction in code before a sprint is spent building it.

I've shipped production work this way for over fifteen years across studio, telco and banking. I came to interface design through type, so the typographic standard in your brief is already instinct, and the same judgment carries whether the surface is product, brand or marketing. I lead

a senior design team and drive design and technical decisions across product and engineering, including presenting the annual design review to several thousand engineers.

My portfolio is at terrygillespie.com/product-designer. Thanks for considering me.

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